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Non-human organs can now be used in transplant

DUBAI
BY ASHWANI KUMAR
Chief Reporter

The UAE Government has issued a Federal Decree-Law introducing major amendments to the national legislation governing the donation and transplantation of organs and tissues, expanding its scope to permit the use of animal-derived or manufactured organs under stringent regulatory oversight.

Under the amendments, “non-human organs” are now formally defined to include animal and manufactured organs. Their use in transplants will be permitted only when considered the most appropriate medical option for a patient’s condition. The decree-law mandates that no animal organ may be removed for transplantation without a licence from the Ministry of Health and Prevention (MoHAP) or the relevant health authority.

The revised law introduces tough penalties for violations, with imprisonment or fines ranging from Dh100,000 to Dh2 million.



AP

VENEZUELAN OPPOSITION LEADER GETS NOBEL IN ABSENTIA

The daughter of the Nobel Peace Prize laureate, Ana Corina Sosa, accepts the award on behalf of her mother, Venezuelan opposition leader Maria Corina Machado, during the Nobel Peace Prize ceremony at Oslo City Hall, Norway, on Wednesday. Machado has been in hiding and has not been seen in public since January 9, when she was briefly detained after joining supporters in a protest in Caracas, Venezuela’s capital.

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World Cup tickets won't guarantee UAE fans a US visa

PRIORITY APPOINTMENT SCHEDULING SYSTEM TO EXPEDITE VISA INTERVIEWS

DUBAI
BY DHANUSHA GOKULAN
Chief Reporter

UAE-based football fans holding a World Cup ticket are not guaranteed admission to the United States, the US Embassy in the UAE clarified, as excitement builds for next year’s tournament.

“The United States is prepared to welcome visitors from the UAE and around the globe for what will be the largest and greatest Fifa World Cup in history,” a US Embassy spokesperson told *Gulf News*.

“However, a World Cup ticket does not guarantee a US visa, nor does it affect the length of stay granted in the United States,” the spokesperson explained.

The Embassy also clarified that the most common visa for tourists travelling to the United States to attend a sporting event is the standard B1/B2 visitor visa. “There are no special or event-specific visas for World Cup ticket

holders. All applicants must meet the eligibility requirements under US law,” the spokesperson stated.

Priority visa interviews

The Embassy confirmed that fans can book priority visa interviews through the new Fifa Priority Appointment Scheduling System (PASS). The system is designed to expedite access to interview slots for those who already hold match tickets.

“This pass will give Fifa World Cup ticket holders who need a US visa the opportunity to schedule a prioritised interview appointment when they submit their application,” the Embassy spokesperson explained.

The PASS system has not yet gone live, and there is no confirmed start date. Officials have stressed that the priority system will not change the rules or standards used to decide who qualifies for a visa. The Embassy has repeatedly underlined that standard US immigration rules will continue to apply to all applicants, including World Cup fans.

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